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Maritime & Coastguard Agency

Guidance

MGN 677 (M) Guidance on the Merchant Shipping (High Speed Craft) Regulations 2022 (SI 2022/1219) and the High Speed Craft Codes 1994 and 2000

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Contents

Summary

This Marine Guidance Note provides guidance to clarify the application of certain requirements in Chapter X of the Annex to the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea, 1974 (SOLAS), including the High Speed Craft (HSC) Codes, 1994 and 2000.

1. Introduction/background

1.1 This MGN provides guidance to assist with the understanding of certain aspects of the International Maritime Organization (IMO) High Speed Craft (HSC) Codes 1994 and 2000, applied in UK law by the Merchant Shipping (High Speed Craft) Regulation 2022 (SI 2022/1219) ("the new Regulations"), which the Maritime and Coastguard Agency (MCA) considers do need clarification.

1.2 The new Regulations give effect to updates to Chapter X of the Annex to the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea, 1974 (SOLAS), including the HSC Codes, 1994 and 2000, since its last implementation into UK law (when amendments by the Merchant Shipping (Passenger Ships on Domestic Voyages) (Amendment) Regulations 2012 (SI 2012/2636) to the Merchant Shipping (High Speed Craft) Regulations 2004 (SI 2004/0302) came into force). The new Regulations also introduce an ambulatory reference provision to bring into force in UK law any future technical amendments to Chapter X and the Codes at the same time as they come into force internationally, without the requirement for additional secondary legislation. The UK government will retain the power to prevent any such amendments taking effect in UK law.

1.3 International instruments (including SOLAS) not only impose mandatory requirements on ships etc. but also allow discretion as to how to implement certain requirements (often in accordance with internally agreed guidance). Therefore, the international text does not in all cases provide sufficient clarity for the requirements to be fully understood and implemented domestically. This includes situations, for example, where the international obligation provides that a ship builder, shipowner or operator is required to do something “to the satisfaction of the Administration”. This MGN therefore provides additional guidance and clarification to assist the reader with compliance with the obligations contained in Chapter X (including the HSC Code 1994 and the HSC Code 2000) where this is considered necessary. However, it should also be borne in mind that the IMO has designed the HSC Codes so as to set risk-based standards. This approach provides additional flexibility over the more traditional, prescriptive approach, but means that fewer definite outcomes can be set out in this MGN. In cases of doubt, the reader should contact their local MCA Marine Office for further clarification.

1.4 This MGN does not cover Chapter X and the Codes provision by provision, but instead addresses only those provisions which are considered to require clarification. This includes some instances where the HSC Codes provide that something must be done to the “satisfaction of the Administration”. Where we have not provided any such clarification, this is because there is no single prescriptive arrangement, or a sufficiently small number of options, which can be set out in this MGN.

2. General statement on High Speed Craft (HSC) Codes

2.1 The HSC Codes are risk-based; due to this the overall safety standard of the vessel is assessed holistically and this approach forms the basis for the HSC Codes throughout. The Codes marked a shift in stance by the IMO from wholly prescriptive regulation to a goal-based approach due to the unique and varying nature of these types of vessels. This is explained in the preamble to each of the HSC Codes 1994 and 2000.

2.2 The Merchant Shipping (High Speed Craft) Regulations 2004 applied the HSC 1994 and 2000 Codes so as to enable updates to them to be given effect in UK law, and require high speed craft to comply with the Codes based on their construction date (or the dates on which they underwent major repairs etc.).

2.3 During the construction of HSC vessels, a significant number of items are required to be done "to the satisfaction of the Administration". It is not possible or practical to prescribe all the matters in respect of which the Administration must be satisfied. The high speed craft as-a-whole is risk assessed and the intended aim of the new regulatory framework is assessed along with Failure Mode Effect and Analysis (FMEA) which must be undertaken. It is not prescriptive by intent and doing so would significantly defeat the intention of the Code and stifle innovation in the industry.

2.4 There are a significant number of intertwining factors that are assessed to decide whether an item which is not prescriptive is acceptable. The following tables identify the areas in respect of which an individual approach is not possible nor an interpretation that would be suitable nor possible to be used in all circumstances.

3. Guidance on the High Speed Craft Code 1994

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2.2.1	The Administration may require a larger reserve of buoyancy to permit the craft to operate in any of its intended modes. This reserve of buoyancy should be calculated by including only those compartments	This will be dealt with on a case-by-case The owner/ builder will need to apply to th at the setup build of the vessel; in consult with the stability unit, the modes, number persons, operational area and seasonal li would be assessed and a risk-based ana undertaken.

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	which are: .1 watertight; .2 accepted as having scantlings and arrangements adequate to maintain their watertight integrity; and .3 situated in locations below a datum, which may be a watertight deck or equivalent structure of a non-watertight deck covered by a weathertight structure as defined in 2.2.3.1.	
2.7.5	Following any inclining or lightweight survey the master should be supplied with amended stability information if the Administration so requires. The information so supplied should be submitted to the Administration for approval, together with a copy thereof for their retention and should incorporate such additions and	The UK administration will take into accou relevant factors including, but not necess limited to: a) control of weights and adjustments ma b) quantity of change; c) type of vessel; d) the stability margins which were alreac present in the stability information for the e) whether damage criteria has been affe the result; f) the reason for the including or lightweig From this and discussion with Stability Ur result in a new stability information book (

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	amendments as the Administration may in any particular case require.	an addendum. If margins were included i Stability Information, the book would only endorsed as remaining extant.
3.4	Cyclic loads, including those from vibrations which can occur on the craft should not: .1 impair the integrity of structure during the anticipated service life of the craft or the service life agreed with the Administration; .2 hinder normal functioning of machinery and equipment; and .3 impair the ability of the crew to carry out its duties.	The UK will require vessels to adhere to t Noise and Vibration Codes regardless. W this is not possible, e.g. in a hovercraft cc alternative means will be required, e.g. bu ear defenders with communications head used during operation. This decision wou based on the noise measurement results monitored at future Surveys. If within acceptable limits, the UK would r prescribe a higher standard than that set the above Codes.
3.6	If the Administration considers it necessary, it should require full-scale trials to be undertaken in which loadings are determined. Cognizance should be taken of the results where these indicate that loading assumptions or structural	Full trials are dependent on the craft. If it novel design or material where Finite Ele Analysis (FEA) could not be used, the Uk require trials with sensors to model actua levels. If it is a complex and innovative design, tl may be required. The decision would be i the MCA on the basis of information recei from the owner or builder.

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	calculations have been inadequate.	
7.2.4	“Non-combustible material” is a material which neither burns nor gives off flammable vapours in sufficient quantity for self-ignition when heated to approximately 750°C, this being determined **to the satisfaction of the Administration** by an established test procedure.** Any other material is a combustible material. ** Refer to the Improved recommendation on test method for qualifying marine construction materials as non-combustible adopted by the Organization by resolution A.799(19).	The UK uses Resolution A.799(19) in this
Note 2 to Table 7.4.2	Where adjacent spaces are in the same alphabetical category and a note 2 appears, a bulkhead or deck	These cases will be considered by the M(case-by-case basis.

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	between such spaces need not be fitted **if deemed unnecessary by the Administration.** For example, a bulkhead need not be required between two store-rooms. A bulkhead is, however, required between a machinery space and a special category space even though both spaces are in the same category.	
7.7.2.1.8	Where the fire detection system does not include means of remotely identifying each detector individually, no section covering more than one deck within accommodation spaces, service spaces and control stations should normally be permitted except a section which covers an enclosed stairway. In order to avoid delay in identifying the	The number of enclosed spaces permitte each section would depend on the Gener Arrangement (GA) of the vessel, surroun spaces, operation, manning, craft type in material, and a risk-based approach woul taken.

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	source of fire, the number of enclosed spaces included in each section should be limited as determined by the Administration. In no case should more than 50 enclosed spaces be permitted in any section. If the detection system is fitted with remotely and individually identifiable fire detectors, the sections may cover several decks and serve any number of enclosed spaces.	
7.7.2.1.9	In passenger craft, if there is no fire detection system capable of remotely and individually identifying each detector, a section of detectors should not serve spaces on both sides of the craft nor on more than one deck and neither should it be situated in more than one zone according to 7.11.1 except that	The UK will consider this if requested by t vessel owner by assessing the GA of the surrounding spaces, operation, manning, type including material, and a risk-based approach would be taken. NB: “The same section of detectors may spaces on more than one deck if such sp are located in the fore or aft end of the cra they are so arranged that they constitute common spaces on different decks (e.g. f rooms, galleys, public spaces, etc.).” MSC/Circ.911

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	the Administration, if it is satisfied that the protection of the craft against fire will not thereby be reduced, may permit such a section of detectors to serve both sides of the craft and more than one deck. In passenger craft fitted with individually identifiable fire detectors, a section may serve spaces on both sides of the craft and on several decks.	
7.7.2.1.11	Detectors should be operated by heat, smoke or other products of combustion, flame, or any combination of these factors. Detectors operated by other factors indicative of incipient fires may be considered by the Administration provided that they are no less sensitive than such detectors. Flame detectors	The UK will only consider detectors opera factors other than heat, smoke or other p of combustion, or flame if they are no les sensitive than such detectors.

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	should only be used in addition to smoke or heat detectors.	
7.7.2.2.5	The Administration may require or permit other spacings based upon test data which demonstrate the characteristics of the detectors	The UK will make any decision based on evidence available.
7.7.2.3.2	Smoke detectors required by paragraph 7.7.2.2.2 should be certified to operate before the smoke density exceeds 12.5% obscuration per metre, but not until the smoke density exceeds 2% obscuration per metre. Smoke detectors to be installed in other spaces should operate within sensitivity limits to the satisfaction of the Administration having regard to the avoidance of detector insensitivity or over- sensitivity.	The UK will consider this if requested by vessel owner by assessing the GA of the surrounding spaces, operation, manning, type including material, and a risk-based approach would be taken.

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7.7.2.3.4	At the discretion of the Administration, the permissible temperature of operation of heat detectors may be increased to 30°C above the maximum deckhead temperature in drying rooms and similar spaces of a normal high ambient temperature.	The UK allows this in such spaces where evidenced that the normal operating conc above this temperature resulting in spuric alarms and where a smoke alarm is not appropriate. This is normally deduced wh vessel is in operation and sea trials, but g not before. It may however be expected f planning stage in spaces such as the gall drying rooms and Saunas. The temperature of operation of heat dete spaces as required by the Code may be 1 in saunas up to 140°C.
7.7.6.1.2	The use of a fire-extinguishing medium which, in the opinion of the Administration, either by itself or under expected conditions of use will adversely affect the earth's ozone layer and/or gives off toxic gases in such quantities as to endanger persons should not be permitted.	The medium in use would be Marine Equ Directive (MED) and Recognised Organis (RO) type approved and assessed under Country Ozone depleting substances requirements. This would be required to meet MARPOL VI.
7.7.8.5	Each fire hose should be of non-perishable material and have a maximum length approved by the Administration.	Hose length will be assessed and tested the sea trails and mandatory drill. An asse will be made to establish that the hoses c are suitable for the space(s) they are inte serve. For this reason no specific definition of wl

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	Fire hoses, together with any necessary fittings and tools, should be kept ready for use in conspicuous positions near the hydrants. All fire hoses in interior locations should be connected to the hydrants at all times. One fire hose should be provided for each hydrant as required by .4.	acceptable is possible, however, MSC/Ci states that “Fire hoses should have a length of: - at least 10 m, - not more than 15 m in machinery space - not more than 20 m for other spaces an decks. Ships carrying dangerous goods should b provided with 3 additional hoses and 3 ac Nozzles” The UK will use a common-sense approa the satisfaction of the attending surveyor equipment can be used properly e.g. a si where a hose is liable to kink would not b acceptable.
7.8.2	Fixed fire-extinguishing system* Each special category space should be fitted with an approved fixed pressure water-spraying system for manual operation which should protect all parts of any deck and vehicle platform in such space, provided that the Administration may permit the use of any other fixed fire-	Testing of systems will be considered as appropriate.

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	extinguishing system that has been shown by full-scale test in conditions simulating a flowing petrol fire in a special category space to be not less effective in controlling fires likely to occur in such a space. * Refer to the Recommendation on fixed fire-extinguishing systems for special category spaces, adopted by the Organization by resolution A.123(V).	
7.10.1.2	The Administration may require additional sets of personal equipment and breathing apparatus, having due regard to the size and type of the craft.	The UK will make decisions on this on a c case basis, considering any relevant facto may include: a) on a large vessel, if the minimum numb sets are a long way from a position, to sa additional sets may be required. This wou more critical depending upon the vessel r function and service area; b) more sets may be required where there possibility of the Breathing Apparatus (BA station becoming cut off or un useable in event of a fire; c) depending on the type of craft involved loss of a system may result in the vessel

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		reduced capability to react to a fire and pr to a port of refuge as quickly as under no conditions. The above factors would feed into the FM Report.
7.10.3.2.1	A breathing apparatus of an approved type which may be either: .1 a smoke helmet or smoke mask which should be provided with a suitable air pump and a length of air hose sufficient to reach from the open deck, well clear of hatch or doorway, to any part of the holds or machinery spaces. If, in order to comply with this subparagraph, an air hose exceeding 36 m in length would be necessary, a self-contained breathing apparatus should be substituted or provided in addition as determined by the Administration;	The UK recognises clothing meeting the requirements of ISO 6942:2002 as meeti necessary requirements. MSC/Circ.911 - Interpretations of Fire Pro Related Provisions of the HSC Code prov further guidance.
8.1.3	Before giving approval to life-saving appliances	The UK requires compliance with MSC.2: Adoption of Amendments to the Revised Recommendation on Testing of Life-Savi

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	and arrangements, the Administration should ensure that such life-saving appliances and arrangements: .1 are tested to confirm that they comply with the requirements of this chapter, in accordance with the recommendations of the Organization;* or .2 have successfully undergone, to the satisfaction of the Administration, tests which are substantially equivalent to those specified in those recommendations	Appliances, as Amended. See also MSC/Circ.980 - Standardized Li Saving Appliance Evaluation and Test Re Forms. Equivalence or Alternative Design Arrang are assessed on a case-by-case basis.
8.1.4	Before giving approval to novel life-saving appliances or arrangements, the Administration should ensure that such appliances or arrangements: .1 provide safety standards at least equivalent to the requirements of	The UK uses IMO guidance, in particular A.520(13) - Code of Practice for the Evalu Testing and Acceptance of Prototype Nov Saving Appliances and Arrangement on a by case basis.

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	this chapter and have been evaluated and tested in accordance with the recommendations of the Organization, or .2 have successfully undergone, to the satisfaction of the Administration, evaluation and tests which are substantially equivalent to those recommendations.	
8.1.6	Except where otherwise provided in this Code, life-saving appliances required by this chapter for which detailed specifications are not included in part C of chapter III of the Convention should be to the satisfaction of the Administration.	The UK will consider these on a case-by-basis.
8.9.1.2	Before giving approval to novel life-saving appliances or arrangements, the Administration should ensure	The UK will consider these on a case-by-basis. See the IMO Life-Saving Appliances (LS/

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	that such appliances or arrangements: .1 provide safety standards at least equivalent to the requirements of this chapter and have been evaluated and tested in accordance with the recommendations of the Organization;* or .2 have successfully undergone, to the satisfaction of the Administration, evaluation and tests which are substantially equivalent to those recommendations.	
8.9.2	Maintenance .1 Instructions for on-board maintenance of life-saving appliances complying with the requirements of regulation III/52 of the Convention should be provided and maintenance should be carried out accordingly. .2 The	The UK requires compliance with IMO Re MSC.81(70) - Revised Recommendation Testing of Life-Saving Appliances as ame and also requires LSA items to be include planned maintenance system.

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	Administration may accept, in lieu of the instructions required by .1, a shipboard planned maintenance programme which includes the requirements of regulation III/52 of the Convention.	
8.9.7.2	In addition to, or in conjunction with, the servicing intervals of marine evacuation systems (MES) required above, each marine evacuation system should be deployed from the craft on a rotational basis at intervals to be agreed by the Administration provided that each system is to be deployed at least once every six years.	See MGN 558 (M) Life-Saving Appliances Marine Evacuation Systems (MES) - Serv and Deployments states our requirements
8.10.2	Where the Administration considers it appropriate, in view of the sheltered nature of the voyages and the suitable	The UK uses the criteria within Annex 10 HSC Code 1994 in line with factors stated nature of voyage etc.

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	climatic conditions of the intended area of operations, the Administration may permit the use of open reversible inflatable liferafts complying with annex 10 on category	
10.2.4.7.2	Other oil-level gauges may be used in place of sounding pipes. Such means should be subject to the following conditions: .1 In passenger craft, such means should not require penetration below the top of the tank and their failure or overfilling of the tanks will not permit release of fuel. .2 The use of cylindrical gauge glasses should be prohibited. In cargo craft, the Administration may permit the use of oil-level gauges with flat glasses and self-closing valves between the gauges and fuel	The UK will assess this on a case-by-cas

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	tanks. Such other means should be acceptable to the Administration and should be maintained in the proper condition to ensure their continued accurate functioning in service.	
10.2.4.9	Oil fuel pipes and their valves and fittings should be of steel or other approved material, except that restricted use of flexible pipes should be permissible in positions where the Administration is satisfied that they are necessary. Such flexible pipes and end attachments should be of approved fire-resisting materials of adequate strength and should be constructed to the satisfaction of the Administration.	The UK uses ISO 15540:2016(en) Ships marine technology - Fire resistance of no metallic hose assemblies and non-metalli compensators - Test methods, and ISO 15541:2016, Ships and marine technolog resistance of non-metallic hose assembli non-metallic compensators - requirement test bench to prove equivalence.
10.3.7	Internal diameters of suction branches should meet the	The UK will consider good engineering pr and evidence through provided calculatio

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	requirements of the Administration but should not be less than 25 mm. Suction branches should be fitted with effective strainers.	
12.2.9	The main busbars should normally be subdivided into at least two parts which should be connected by a circuit-breaker or other approved means. So far as is practicable, the connection of generating sets and any other duplicated equipment should be equally divided between the parts. Equivalent arrangements may be permitted to the satisfaction of the Administration	The UK would consider accepting circuit breakers or fuses of suitable rating and characteristics as a suitable means for subdivision of switchboards.
12.6.1.2	The Administration may require additional precautions for portable electrical equipment for use in confined or exceptionally damp spaces where particular	The voltage of electrical supplies to porta transportable electrical apparatus in all su spaces should be as low as is practicable application. General guidance is given in 8450:2006, Annex A, Code of practice for installation of electrical and electronic equ in ships.

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	risks due to conductivity may exist.	
12.6.2	Main and emergency switchboards should be so arranged as to give easy access, as may be needed, to apparatus and equipment, without danger to personnel. The sides and the rear and, where necessary, the front of switchboards should be suitably guarded. Exposed live parts having voltages to earth exceeding a voltage to be specified by the Administration should not be installed on the front of such switchboards. Where necessary, nonconducting mats or gratings should be provided at the front and rear of the switchboard.	The voltage referred to should be taken a Platforms at the front and rear of switchb must have non-slip surfaces. Where acce live parts within switchboard is normally p the surfaces must, in addition be insulate non-conducting mat or gratings.
12.6.3	When a distribution system, whether	Where visual indication only is provided, i be in a position where it will be included i

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	primary or secondary, for power, heating or lighting, with no connection to earth is used, a device capable of continuously monitoring the insulation level to earth and of giving an audible or visual indication of abnormally low insulation values should be provided. For limited secondary distribution systems the Administration may accept a device for manual checking of the insulation level.	routine checks, or will be apparent to the within 24 hours.
12.6.4.1	Except as permitted by the Administration in exceptional circumstances, all metal sheaths and armour of cables should be electrically continuous and should be earthed.	The UK allows relaxation for limited instrumentation circuits where the manufa of the devices require cable sheaths not t earthed.
12.6.4.3	All electric cables and wiring external to equipment should be at least of a	Cable runs should, as far as practicable, routes which pass over or near the top of engines and oil-fired equipment, or near t surfaces e.g. diesel engine exhaust syste Where there is no alternative route, cable

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	flame-retardant type and should be so installed as not to impair their original flame-retarding properties. Where necessary for particular applications, the Administration may permit the use of special types of cables such as radio frequency cables, which do not comply with the foregoing.	should be protected from heat and fire da Such fire protection may be in the form of plate or trunk, due account being taken o effects on cable rating, if appropriate.
12.6.4.4	Where cables which are installed in hazardous areas introduce the risk of fire or explosion in the event of an electrical fault in such areas, special precautions against such risks should be taken to the satisfaction of the Administration.	Cable for non-intrinsically safe circuits in hazardous areas should be either: .1 of the mineral insulated metal covered .2 protected by electrically continuous me sheathing or metallic wire armour, braid c or .3 enclosed in screwed heavy gauge stee drawn or seam welded and galvanised cc The conduit should be made gas tight wit respect to hazardous areas.
12.6.5.1	Each separate circuit should be protected against short circuit and against overload, except as permitted in 12.5, or where the	The UK will consider this on a case by ca using justification by calculation and asse of risk and mitigation.

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	Administration may exceptionally otherwise permit.	
12.7.4.4.1	For a period of 12h; the navigational equipment as required by chapter 13. Where such provision is unreasonable or impracticable, the Administration may waive this requirement for craft of less than 5,000 gross tonnage.	The UK would consider this for short, res voyages only i.e., if the normal operating crossing is 4 hours, search and rescue fa are close and depending on the business shipping lane it may be possible to reduc criteria based on evidence provided.
12.7.4.6	For a period of 10 min, power drives for directional control devices including those required to direct thrust forward and astern, unless there is a manual alternative acceptable to the Administration as complying with 5.2.3.	The UK may consider manual alternative hand operated solenoids, valves, tillers, a pumps which are connected in an emerg These are assessed on a case by case b must be proven during sea trials.

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13.1.1 – 13.1.3	13.1.1 This chapter covers equipment which relates to the navigation of the craft as distinct from the safe functioning of the craft. The following paragraphs represent the minimum requirements for normal safe navigation unless it is demonstrated to the Administration that an equivalent level of safety is achieved by other means. 13.1.2 The equipment and its installation should be to the satisfaction of the Administration. 13.1.3 The Administration should determine to what extent the provisions of this chapter do not apply to craft below 150 gross tonnage.	The UK would consider alternative mean case by case basis. Only Marine Equipm Directive (MED) (in accordance with the Merchant Shipping (Marine Equipment) Regulations 2016) or UK equivalent appr equipment will be permitted. A flux gate compass may be considered i magnetic compass with duplication.
13.7.1	A rate-of-turn indicator should	The UK would consider this on a case by basis.

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	be provided unless the Administration determines otherwise. Means should be provided to warn the operator if an operationally dictated maximum rate of turn is being reached.	
13.16.1	All equipment to which this chapter applies should be of a type approved by the Administration. Subject to 13.13.2, such equipment should conform to performance standards not inferior to those adopted by the Organization.	MED equipment or UK equivalent is requ the UK on HSC.
15.3.1	The operating station should be placed above all other superstructures so that the operating crew are able to gain a view all-round the horizon from the navigating workstation. Where it is impractical to meet the	The UK requires compliance with the pre: requirements of the Code.

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	requirements of this paragraph from a single navigating workstation, the operating station should be designed so that an all-round view of the horizon is obtained using two navigating workstations combined or any other means to the satisfaction of the Administration.	
15.3.4	Where it is considered necessary by the Administration, the field of vision from the navigating workstation should permit the navigators from this position to utilize leading marks astern of the craft for track monitoring.	The UK requires compliance with the pre requirements of the Code.
15.4.10	In craft where the Administration considers the provision of a safety belt necessary for use by the operating crew, it should be possible for those operating crew	The UK will assess the situation includin effect on crew on a case by case basis d heavy weather trials.

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	members, with their safety belts correctly worn, to comply with 15.4.4 except in respect of controls which it can be shown will only be required on very rare occasions and which are not associated with the need for safety restraint.	
15.5.8	If considered necessary by the Administration, the operating compartment should be provided with a suitable table for chart work. There should be facilities for lighting the chart. Chart table lighting should be screened.	If the backup arrangement to ECDIS is na paper charts, the UK will require a suitabl table to be fitted.
18.1.1	The High Speed Craft Safety Certificate, the Permit to Operate High Speed Craft or certified copies thereof, and copies of the route operational manual, craft operating manual, and a copy of such elements of the maintenance	The UK will require the items stated and t maintenance manual records.

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	manual as the Administration may require, should be carried on board.	
18.1.3.17	Arrangements to ensure that equipment is maintained in compliance with the Administration's requirements, and to ensure co-ordination of information as to the serviceability of the craft and equipment between the operating and maintenance elements of the operator's organization;	The MCA requires the equipment to be maintained in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions, plus in comp with any other relevant UK legislation rela where this imposes additional requiremer
18.2.1.17	…in particular, the manual should provide information, in clearly defined chapters approved specifically by the Administration, relating to: .17.1 indication of emergency situations or malfunctions jeopardizing safety, required	The UK would not require anything other what is stated in the paragraph.

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	actions to be taken and any consequential restrictions on operation of the craft or its machinery; .17.2 evacuation procedures; .17.3 operating limitations including the worst intended conditions; .17.4 limiting values of all machinery parameters requiring compliance for safe operation. In regard to information on machinery or system failures, data should take into account the results of any FMEA reports developed during the craft design.	
18.3.1	The level of competence and the training considered necessary in respect of the master and each crew member should be laid	The type rating training revalidation and requirements are set out MSN 1740 (M) - Training and Certification of Officers and High-Speed Craft. These must be approv the MCA. MSN 1740(M): https://www.gov.uk/government/publicatic

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	down and demonstrated in the light of the following guidelines to the satisfaction of the Administration in respect of the particular type and model of craft concerned and the service intended. More than one crew member should be trained to perform all essential operational tasks in both normal and emergency situations.	1740-training-and-certification-of-officers-crew-on-high-speed-craft
18.3.2	The Administration should specify an appropriate period of operational training for the master and each member of the crew and, if necessary, the periods at which appropriate re-training should be carried out.	The Master and all officers having an ope role should hold a Route and Craft specif Rating Certificate issued on behalf of the (for UK Flag vessels) and all other crew members should complete type rating tra before being employed on a craft – refer 1740(M) Training and Certification of Offic Crew on High Speed Craft and MGN 26(I Speed Craft Training – Further Guidance Course Approval and Certification. MGN https://www.gov.uk/government/publicatic 026-hsc-further-guidance-on-course-appr certification

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18.3.5	The type rating certificate should be re-validated every two years and the Administration should lay down the procedures for re-validation.	See MSN 1740 (M) - Training and Certific Officers and Crew on High-Speed Craft: https://www.gov.uk/government/publicatic 1740-training-and-certification-of-officers- crew-on-high-speed-craft cover type ratin training and the approval.
18.3.7	The Administration should specify standards of physical fitness and frequency of medical examinations having regard to the route and craft concerned.	Advice on UK medical certification require can be found in MSN 1887(M): https://www.gov.uk/government/publicatic 1887-maritime-labour-convention-medica certification and on GOV.UK at the follow https://www.gov.uk/guidance/seafarers-m certification-guidance
18.5.8	The date when musters are held, details of abandon craft drills and fire drills, drills of other life- saving appliances, enclosed space entry and rescue drills, and onboard training should be recorded in such logbook as may be prescribed by the Administration.	Vessels must carry Log Books in accorda with the Merchant Shipping (Official Log I Regulations 1981 (SI 1981/569).
19.2.1 – 19.2.2	.1 routine preventive inspection and maintenance	The MCA requires the equipment to be in and maintained in accordance with the manufacturer’s instructions, maintenance manuals, service bulletins, and notices /

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	should be performed to a schedule approved by the Administration, which should have regard at least in the first instance to the manufacturer's schedule; .2 in the performance of maintenance tasks, due regard should be paid to maintenance manuals, service bulletins acceptable to the Administration and to any additional instructions of the Administration in this respect;	instructions issued by the MCA, plus in compliance with any other relevant UK le relating to it where this imposes additiona requirements.

4. Guidance on the High Speed Craft Code, 2000

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2.2.7.1	…Conformity with the requirements of organizations recognized by the	The UK will accept compliance with the any UK approved Recognised Organisa

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	Administration in accordance with regulation XI/1 of the Convention may be considered to possess adequate strength.	
2.2.7.2	For doors in weathertight superstructures, hose tests shall be carried out with a water pressure from the outside in accordance with specifications at least equivalent to those acceptable to the Organization.	Arrangements complying with ISO 6042 satisfactory by the UK.
2.2.8.4.2	Ventilators the coamings of which extend to more than one metre above the deck or which are fitted to decks above the datum need not be fitted with closing arrangements unless they face forward or are specifically required by the Administration.	The UK does not normally require closi situation, however, in the instance of a point a form of closing arrangement wo This would be reviewed on a case by ca
2.8	… The Administration may accept the use of an electronic loading and stability computer or	The UK accepts the use of electronic lo stability. The MCA's Instructions to Surv refer: https://www.gov.uk/government/publicat hsc-code-2000-2008-edition-msis-34

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	equivalent means for this purpose.	and MSIS 3 section 5.5 has further infor https://www.gov.uk/government/publicat ship-construction-classes-i-ii-and-ii-a-m In certain cases, it may be possible for v exempted from the requirement to calcu stability prior to departure. Examples of exemption may be considered are as fo 1. Where a vessel makes regular voyag the same place in conditions of loading closely to conditions in the approved St Booklet. 2. Where the maximum deadweight whi capable of carrying does not exceed x t lightship displacement. Values of x and from MCA Survey and Inspection. 3. Where the actual draught / deadweig exceed z % of the subdivision draught / Values of z can be attained from MCA S Inspection. In cases 1 - 3 the following procedures place: - Before the ship departs port, confirma required that the actual condition of load closely to one of the approved loading c contained in the Stability Information Bo - The approved loading condition corres actual loading condition is to be recorde retained on board for this purpose. - The approved loading conditions shou vessels normal operating pattern and sh sufficient reserve below the maximum a account for minor variations in trim, carg free surface moment etc. (KG is the ver (along the ship's centreline) between th Vertical Centre of Gravity (VCG))

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		4. Where the approved loading conditio pessimistic (high) VCG for cargo and it maximum allowable VCG cannot be exc practical loading condition. - In these cases, it will be sufficient for t determine the draught and trim prior to c confirm that these lie within the limiting actual draught and trim should be recor retained onboard for this purpose. It should be noted that when the vessel items which cannot readily be confirmec VCG below the cargo VCG assumed in loading conditions, a full calculation of th loading condition must be made prior to the procedure contained in the approve Information Booklet. Owners wishing to exercise these optio refer their proposals to MCA Survey and Stability Unit.
4.2.2	…The public address system and its performance standards shall be approved by the Administration having regard to the recommendations developed by the organization.*	The UK will assess arrangements in acc MSC/Circ.808 and the Code on Alerts a 2009 in Resolution A.1021(26)*
7.5.6.8	… The use of cylindrical gauge glasses is prohibited, except for cargo craft where the use of oil-level gauges with flat glasses and self-closing	The UK will assess this on a case by ca

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	valves between the gauges and fuel tanks may be permitted by the Administration. …	
7.10.1.3	The Administration may require additional sets of personal equipment and breathing apparatus, having due regard to the size and type of the craft.	The UK will make decisions on this on a basis, considering any relevant factors. a) on a large vessel, if the minimum nur long way from a position, to save time a may be required. This would be more cı upon the vessel material, function and s b) more sets may be required where the possibility of the Breathing Apparatus (E becoming cut off or un useable in the ev c) depending on the type of craft involve system may result in the vessel have re to react to a fire and proceed to a port c quickly as under normal conditions. The above factors would feed into the F Analysis (FEA) Report.
7.17.3.1.2	The quantity of water delivered shall be capable of simultaneously supplying the arrangements required by 7.17.3.1.3 for the largest designated cargo space and the four nozzles of a size and at a pressure as specified in 7.7.5, capable of being trained on any part of the cargo space when empty. This	This will be assessed on a case by case based on a number of factors to review holistically.

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	requirement shall be met by the total capacity of the main fire pump(s) not including the capacity of the emergency fire pump, if fitted. This amount of water may be applied by equivalent means to the satisfaction of the Administration.	
7.17.3.1.5	The requirements of 7.17.3.1.1 to 7.17.3.1.4 may be fulfilled by a water spray system approved by the Administration based on the standards developed by the Organization* , provided that the amount of water required for fire-fighting purposes in the largest cargo space allows simultaneous use of the water spray system plus four jets of water from hose nozzles in accordance with 7.17.3.1.2.	The UK refers to paragraphs 9.2, 9.3 ar Interim guidelines for open-top containe (MSC/Circ.608/Rev.1) for standards de\ Organization. Case by case basis for al innovative solutions will be considered.
8.1.2	Except where otherwise provided in this Code, the life-saving appliances and	LSA meeting the requirements of Chapt and the LSA Code will be accepted by t administration.

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	arrangements required by this chapter shall meet the detailed specifications set out in chapter III of the Convention and the LSA Code and be approved by the Administration.	
8.1.6	Except where otherwise provided in this Code, life-saving appliances required by this chapter for which detailed specifications are not included in the LSA Code shall be to the satisfaction of the Administration.	The UK will consider these situations or basis. The UK uses IMO MSC.1/Circ.14 For The Approval Of Alternatives And E provided for in various IMO Instruments on alternative design and arrangements Chapters II-1 and III (MSC.1/Circ.1212) basis for application.
8.1.8	Procedures adopted by the Administration for approval shall also include the conditions whereby approval would continue or would be withdrawn.	This is for novel arrangements
8.6.1	The Administrations may permit the use of adjustable securing and/or bowsing lines at exits where more than one survival craft is used.	The UK permits this on domestic HSC v Reversible Liferafts (ORL) are used, an in other places as multiple ORLs are "st guidance is contained in the MCA's Inst Surveyors MSIS 24: https://www.gov.uk/government/publicat craft-international-safety-code-msis-24

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10.3.7	Internal diameters of suction branches shall meet the requirements of the Administration but shall not be less than 25 mm.	The UK will consider good engineering evidence through provided calculations.
12.6.3	…For limited secondary distribution systems the Administration may accept a device for manual checking of the insulation level.	Where visual indication only is provided position where it will be included in routi be apparent to the crew within 24 hours
12.6.4.4	Where cables which are installed in hazardous areas introduce the risk of fire or explosion in the event of an electrical fault in such areas, special precautions against such risks shall be taken to the satisfaction of the Administration.	Cable for non-intrinsically safe circuits ir areas should be either: .1 of the mineral insulated metal covere .2 protected by electrically continuous n metallic wire armour, braid or tape; or .3 enclosed in screwed heavy gauge ste seam welded and galvanised conduit. T be made gas tight with respect to hazar
12.6.10	The following additional requirements from .1 to .7 shall be met, and requirements from .8 to .13 shall be met also for non-metallic craft: .1 The electrical distribution voltages	Higher voltages would be accepted for p per 12.6.10.2 to 13 of the MCA's Instruc Surveyors MSIS 24 https://www.gov.uk/government/publicat craft-international-safety-code-msis-24 For other items, the MCA would conside case-by-case basis.

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	throughout the craft may be either direct current or alternating current and shall not exceed: .1.1 500 V for cooking, heating and other permanently connected equipment; and .1.2 250 V for lighting, internal communications and receptacle outlets. The Administration may accept higher voltages for propulsion purposes.	
12.8.2.2.5	…for a period of 10 min, power drives for directional control devices, including those required to direct thrust forward and astern, unless there is a manual alternative acceptable to the Administration as complying with 5.2.3.	The UK may consider manual alternativ operated solenoids, valves, tillers, air dr which are connected in an emergency. assessed on a case by case basis and during sea trials.

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13.1.2	The equipment and its installation shall be to the satisfaction of the Administration. The Administration shall determine to what extent the provisions of this chapter do not apply to craft below 150 gross tonnage.	The UK would consider alternative mea case basis. Only Marine Equipment Dir equipment will be permitted. A flux gate compass may be considerec magnetic compass with duplication.
13.17.1	All equipment to which this chapter applies shall be of a type approved by the Administration. Such equipment shall conform to performance standards not inferior to those adopted by the Organization.	MED equipment is required by the UK c
13.17.2	The Administration shall require that manufacturers have a quality control system audited by a competent authority to ensure continuous compliance with the type approval conditions. Alternatively, the Administration may use final product verification procedures where compliance with the	This is undertaken as part of what was Equipment Directive (MED) approval pr be from a UK approved Recognised Or But see MIN 590(M+F) Amendment 4 fc assessment procedures for marine equi the transition period: https://www.gov.uk/government/publicat amendment-4-mf-uk-conformity-assess for-marine-equipment-following-the-tran The MED also covers testing of one-off

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	type approval certificate is verified by a competent authority before the product is installed on board craft.	
14.15.6	On craft engaged on voyages in sea areas A1 and A2, the availability shall be ensured by using such methods as duplication of equipment, shore-based maintenance or at-sea electronic maintenance capability, or a combination of these, as may be approved by the Administration.	The UK will consider these on a case b
14.15.7	On craft engaged on voyages in sea areas A3 and A4, the availability shall be ensured by using a combination of at least two methods, such as duplication of equipment, shore-based maintenance or at-sea electronic maintenance capability, as may be approved by the Administration, taking into account the recommendations	The UK will consider these on a case b Guidance already exists within the High Code 2000 (which is cross-referenced i in the footnote to 14.15.7 – “Administrat account of the Radio maintenance guid global maritime distress and safety syst related to sea areas A3 and A4, adopte Organization by resolution A.702(17)”.

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	of the Organization.**	
14.15.8	However, for craft operating solely between ports where adequate facilities for shore-based maintenance of the radio installations are available and provided no journey between two such ports exceeds six hours, then the Administration may exempt such craft from the requirement to use at least two maintenance methods. For such craft at least one maintenance method shall be used.	The UK will consider exemptions on a c basis.
14.16.1	Every craft shall carry personnel qualified for distress and safety radiocommunication purposes to the satisfaction of the Administration.	Requirements are specified in the Safe Document, and are dependent on the s operation of the vessel. In the event it is the Safe Manning document, the Permi would contain this information. The UK General Operator's Certificate in this sit
14.17	A record shall be kept, to the satisfaction of the Administration and as required by the Radio Regulations, of all incidents	The UK requires vessels to maintain a r format to allow verification. There is no for this.

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	connected with the radiocommunication service which appear to be of importance to safety of life at sea.	
15.3.1	Where it is impractical to meet the requirements of this paragraph from a single navigating workstation, the operating station shall be designed so that an all-round view of the horizon is obtained by using two navigating workstations combined or by any other means to the satisfaction of the Administration.	The UK requires compliance with the pr requirements of the Code.
15.3.4	Where it is considered necessary by the Administration, the field of vision from the navigating workstation shall permit the navigators from this position to utilize leading marks astern of the craft for track monitoring.	The UK requires compliance with the pr requirements of the Code.
15.5.8	If considered necessary by the Administration, the operating compartment shall	If the vessel's backup arrangement to E of nautical paper charts, the UK will req chart table to be fitted.

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	be provided with a suitable table for chart work. There shall be facilities for lighting the chart. Chart-table lighting shall be screened.	
18.1.1	The High-Speed Craft Safety Certificate, the Permit to Operate High-Speed Craft or certified copies thereof, and copies of the route operational manual, craft operating manual, and a copy of such elements of the maintenance manual as the Administration may require shall be carried on board.	The UK will require the items stated anc manual records.

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18.1.3.17	…arrangements to ensure that equipment is maintained in compliance with the Administration's requirements, and to ensure co-ordination of information as to the serviceability of the craft and equipment between the operating and maintenance elements of the operator's organization;	The MCA requires the equipment to be accordance with the manufacturer's ins compliance with any other relevant UK to it where this imposes additional requi
18.1.4	The Administration shall determine the maximum allowable distance from a base port or place of refuge after assessing the provisions made under 18.1.3.	The UK will determine this on a case by
18.3.2	The Administration shall specify an appropriate period of operational training for the master and each member of the crew and, if necessary, the periods at which appropriate retraining shall be carried out.	UK requirement is in accordance with th Shipping (Standards of Training, Certific Watchkeeping) Regulations 2015 (SI 20 MSN 1740(M) https://www.gov.uk/government/publicat maritime-labour-convention-medical-ce GOV.UK pages: https://www.gov.uk/topi sea/training-certification

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18.3.5	The type rating certificate shall be re-validated every two years and the Administration shall lay down the procedures for re-validation.	The UK requirement is in accordance w Shipping (Standards of Training, Certific Watchkeeping) Regulations 2015 (SI 20 https://www.gov.uk/government/publicat training-and-certification-of-officers-and speed-craft and GOV.UK pages: https://www.gov.uk/topic/working-sea/tra
18.3.7	The Administration shall specify standards of physical fitness and frequency of medical examinations, having regard to the route and craft concerned.	The UK requirement is as per the Merch (Maritime Labour Convention) (Medical Regulations 2010 (SI 2010/737) and MS https://www.gov.uk/government/publicat maritime-labour-convention-medical-cer GOV.UK pages: https://www.gov.uk/guid medical-certification-guidance
18.5.8.1	The date when musters are held, details of abandon craft drills and fire drills, drills of other life-saving appliances, enclosed space entry and rescue drills, and onboard training shall be recorded in such log-book as may be prescribed by the Administration.	Vessels must carry Log Books in accord Merchant Shipping (Official Log Books) (SI 1981/569) as amended.

More Information

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